

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy

Dr. Manuel G. Saldivar || Department of Psychological Sciences || UTRGV

In this course, learning means struggling productively — confusion, false starts, and mistakes are part of the process. Real expertise comes from deliberate practice and mental effort, not shortcuts. No one — not even an AI — can do your thinking for you.

Generative AI tools (like ChatGPT, Claude, or Copilot) can be powerful learning partners, but research indicates that *lazy use* (using AI without thinking about what you're doing) can actually weaken your reading, writing, and thinking skills. Therefore, my AI usage rules are structured around two core learning goals:

Making Explicit Connections (AI as a Tutor/Sounding Board)

You MAY use AI to help you preview big picture concepts, clarify dense readings, or test your preconceptions. For example, you can prompt an AI: 'Identify 5 core keywords or historical debates surrounding [Psychological Concept X] so I can better research it in the library databases.' Or: 'Explain this specific abstract theory using a real-world analogy so I can see the big picture before I read the chapter.'

Engaging in Deliberate Practice (AI as a Skill-BUILDER)

You MAY use AI to suggest how to revise a wordy passage in your drafts for clarity, or to generate unique, real-world case studies to test your ability to apply a theory.

Where AI is Strictly Prohibited

You MAY NOT use AI to write discussion posts, create case studies for formal assignments, or answer big picture exam/project questions. In other words: don't let AI do your thinking. That's when learning stops.

Privacy, Copyright, and Ethics Reminders

- **Fact-Check Everything:** Generative AI invents facts and citations—a problem called *AI hallucination*. It also can harbor hidden biases. You are 100% responsible for the accuracy of anything you submit.
- **Data Security:** Never upload copyrighted course materials (like textbook chapters, exam questions, or my lecture notes) or your classmates' work into a public AI system. Once submitted, that data is absorbed into the platform and no longer secure.

When in Doubt, Ask

If you're unsure whether something is allowed, email me or stop by office hours. I'd much rather clarify a question than deal with an academic integrity issue.

The Bottom Line

If an AI tool helps you wrestle with ideas, it's welcome. If it does the thinking for you, it's a violation of academic integrity. Any unapproved or unacknowledged AI-generated content in submitted assessments will be handled according to university academic dishonesty policies.

